

TAILORMATE

TAILORING ORDER MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

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Interviewed Tailor:	Salimatou Alias Mami Sally	Location:	Grand Baobab, Wasa Lamba
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PAGE 1 — PRESENTATION OF THE PROJECT

1. Introduction & Context

TailorMate is a specialized web-based order and production management system engineered to streamline daily tailoring shop operations. Small-scale garment workshops play a central economic and cultural role, yet most rely exclusively on physical ledger books, informal paper notes, or personal memory. The project was initiated following field research and direct interviews with a practicing tailor, **Salimatou Alias Mami Sally**, operating at Grand Baobab, Wasa Lamba. The primary purpose of TailorMate is to provide an intuitive digital hub uniting customer records, garment orders, anatomical body measurements, financial balances, and staff assignments in one dependable platform.

2. Project Objectives

The design of TailorMate is driven by practical operational targets:

- **Customer Repository:** Quickly register and search client profiles and phone numbers.
- **Order & Item Lifecycle:** Track orders broken down into multiple garments (shirts, trousers, caps).
- **Digital Sizing Vault:** Store and recall historical measurements without remeasuring.
- **Financial Accountability:** Record advance deposits and calculate outstanding balances in FCFA.
- **Workforce Coordination:** Assign specific garment tasks (cutting, sewing, finishing) to shop workers.
- **Proactive Deadline Alerts:** Highlight unfinished garments approaching agreed pickup dates.
- **Service Excellence:** Eliminate customer disputes, forgotten orders, and delivery delays.

3. Profile of the Field Partner

The empirical requirements for this project were gathered directly from **Salimatou Alias Mami Sally**. Operating as a sole proprietor in an active artisan workshop at Grand Baobab, Wasa Lamba (Tel: 676 608 447), her business handles substantial garment turnover with apprentice assistants. Her detailed account of daily administrative struggles served as the functional specification for the system.

PAGE 2 — PROBLEM STATEMENT & FIELD ANALYSIS

4. Real-World Problems Identified by the Tailor

Through on-site observation and interviews with Salimatou Alias Mami Sally, two fundamental operational bottlenecks were identified as threatening workshop profitability and reputation:

A. Critical Difficulty Tracking Garment Delivery Deadlines:

As customer orders accumulate, particularly during peak seasons (weddings, back-to-school, and holidays), relying on memory or scattered paper logs makes it impossible to maintain a reliable delivery schedule. New expedited orders arrive while earlier garments are in various intermediate stages of cutting or assembly. Without an automated timeline, the workshop frequently misjudges priorities, leaving garments untouched until the client physically arrives to collect them.

B. Ineffective Task Dispatch and Lack of Staff Accountability:

In a busy atelier with multiple assistants and apprentices, work is divided across specialized steps. The chief tailor reported significant difficulty knowing in real time:

- Which worker is currently handling which specific garment.
- Whether fabric has already been cut, partially assembled, or finished.
- Which pending items are already past or near their delivery date.
- Who is accountable when a garment is delayed, misplaced, or assembled incorrectly.

5. Negative Consequences for the Business

These unmanaged bottlenecks trigger severe compounding problems across the tailoring shop:

- **Chronic Delivery Delays:** Customers arrive on promised dates only to find fabrics unsewn.
- **Erosion of Customer Trust:** Arguments and damaged goodwill lead to lost clientele.
- **Financial & Cash Flow Disputes:** Confusion regarding cash advances versus remaining balances in FCFA.
- **Operational Chaos & Wasted Hours:** Constant interruption to search for lost paper slips or fabrics.
- **Excessive Stress on the Chief Tailor:** Heavy mental fatigue attempting to memorize dozens of deadlines.

6. Rationale for a Computerized Solution

A physical paper notebook cannot calculate days remaining, sort jobs by urgency, or alert a team when a deadline is 24 hours away. TailorMate converts these vulnerable paper routines into an automated, relational database system that enforces order, visibility, and accountability across every workstation in the atelier.

PAGE 3 — PROPOSED SOLUTION & SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

7. The TailorMate Digital Solution

To resolve each difficulty identified by Salimatou Alias Mami Sally, TailorMate implements a modular, database-backed system architecture designed around the tailor's natural workflow:

Module	Key Capabilities	Direct Problem Solved
Customer Management	Fast profile lookup, telephone registry, physical address, and historical customer preferences.	Eliminates misplaced client phone numbers and misidentified customer identities.
Order & Item Breakdown	Supports multi-item orders (e.g. 2 shirts, 2 trousers, 1 cap) with unit prices and individual progress states.	Prevents mixing up garments belonging to the same order; guarantees exact items requested are produced.
Digital Sizing Vault	Secure storage of full anatomical measurements (neck, chest, waist, hips, sleeve, inseam) with timestamps.	Stops lost paper notebooks; enables repeat orders without demanding the customer remeasure.
Payment Tracking	Real-time balance computation in FCFA: Total Order Cost – Advance Deposit = Balance Due on Collection.	Resolves payment disputes; ensures garments are never handed over without full financial settlement.
Staff Delegation	Chief tailor assigns specialized tasks (Cutting, Sewing, Finishing) to named team members (Michael, Paul, David).	Eliminates confusion over who is working on what; establishes direct personal accountability.
Proactive Deadline Radar	Calculates days remaining; highlights incomplete orders due in 24–48 hours with dynamic color-coded badges.	Solves the chief tailor's primary headache by detecting delayed orders before the client arrives.

8. The Operational Workflow of TailorMate

Customer Intake → Measurement Lookup / Entry → Order Itemization → Advance Deposit (FCFA) → Staff Task Assignment → Real-Time Progress Tracking → Deadline Alert Verification → Final Payment & Pickup

PAGE 4 — SYSTEM DEMONSTRATION & HOW IT SOLVES THE PROBLEM

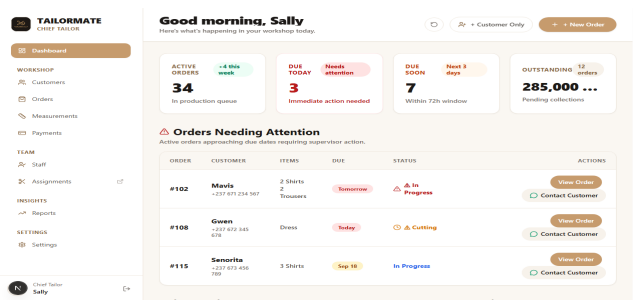


Figure 1: Chief Tailor Dashboard & Deadline Radar

How it solves the problem: Provides an instant bird's-eye view of active orders, urgent deadlines, and payments. Eliminates memory lapses by flagging garments due today or tomorrow before customers arrive.



Figure 2: Order Intake & Garment Itemization

How it solves the problem: Itemizes shirts, trousers, and accessories with prices and delivery dates. Ensures staff never omit a clothing item belonging to a customer's package.



Figure 3: Staff Assignment & Workshop Coordination

How it solves the problem: Assigns cutting, sewing, and finishing tasks to specific assistants. Guarantees total accountability and removes bottlenecks across workshop workstations.



Figure 4: On-Time Delivery & Payment Settlement

How it solves the problem: Automatically reconciles advances and balances in FCFA upon collection. Protects revenue and builds lasting client trust through prompt, reliable fulfillment.

9. Conclusion

TailorMate successfully bridges the gap between traditional tailoring craftsmanship and modern digital efficiency. By tackling the exact field challenges articulated by Salimatou Alias Mami Sally—specifically unreliable deadline monitoring and uncoordinated staff dispatching—the application establishes operational rigor in the workshop. TailorMate demonstrates that a targeted, database-driven system drastically cuts administrative confusion, secures financial margins, and ensures clients receive perfectly tailored garments on schedule.

10. Future Perspectives

Future releases will incorporate automated WhatsApp / SMS ready-for-collection alerts, mobile offline PWA caching, and multi-branch management for expanding ateliers across Cameroon.